Case 21

LEVEL 3 · TRICKY

The Last Train to Wrenfold

Scene: Railway Halt

Albert Dunn, stationmaster at Wrenfold Halt, was found dead in the signal box at seven o'clock on a wet Friday evening. Hattie noticed a chalked notice on the platform board: "6.15 from Market Ashby CANCELLED. Fallen tree on the line." Vera, the ticket clerk, had been serving a long queue in the ticket office since six. Leonard, the relief signalman, was down at the level crossing, holding the gates for a farmer's tractor. Cedric, the porter, had been loading milk churns with the milkman. Augusta, a smartly dressed visitor, told the constable, "I came in on the six-fifteen from Market Ashby and found the poor man like that." Forty years ago, Albert had left Augusta waiting at the altar.

THE SUSPECTS

cross out each one you clear

- ◯ **Vera Rudd** · ticket clerk
  "*I've had a queue at my window since six.*"
- ◯ **Leonard Pye** · relief signalman
  "*I was holding the gates for a tractor.*"
- ◯ **Cedric Hale** · porter
  "*I was loading churns with the milkman.*"
- ◯ **Augusta Fairley** · visitor
  "*I came in on the six-fifteen and found him.*"

Search the evidence on the next page →

Case 21 · The Evidence

LEVEL 3 · TRICKY

Suspects: Vera · Leonard · Cedric · Augusta

W	M	I	L	K	C	H	U	R	N	S	C
F	A	L	L	E	N	T	R	E	E	A	R
U	S	I	U	G	U	S	T	S	A	P	O
M	I	I	T	T	S	G	U	E	I	L	S
B	G	L	T	I	Y	B	E	M	C	A	S
R	N	A	U	M	N	S	E	A	A	T	I
E	A	L	B	E	E	G	R	P	T	F	N
L	L	J	I	T	L	T	R	H	E	O	G
L	B	C	H	A	L	K	B	O	A	R	D
A	O	D	H	B	E	R	A	R	O	M	T
T	X	H	E	L	A	L	T	E	A	M	R
T	I	C	K	E	T	O	F	F	I	C	E

- ☐ CHALKBOARD
- ☐ CROSSING
- ☐ FALLENTREE
- ☐ MILKCHURNS
- ☐ PLATFORM
- ☐ SEMAPHORE
- ☐ SIGNALBOX
- ☐ TICKETOFFICE
- ☐ TIMETABLE
- ☐ UMBRELLA
- ☐ WAITINGROOM

Words read forwards only: across, down, both diagonals.

Write the leftover letters in your Detective's Notebook →

Detective's Notebook · Case 21

The Last Train to Wrenfold

1. The leftover letters

left to right, top row to bottom

_____

_____

_____

2. Clear the suspects

Suspect	Motive?	Chance?	Cleared because…
Vera	☐	☐	_____
Leonard	☐	☐	_____
Cedric	☐	☐	_____
Augusta	☐	☐	_____

3. My verdict

How sure? ◯ A hunch ◯ Fairly sure ◯ Certain!

The culprit is _____

The motive was _____

4. Village Ledger

Letter no. 5 of your verdict goes in Ledger box 26 (page 97).

Hattie's hint (upside down, so you don't peek):

Read the station notice board very carefully.